

Pre-Construction Plan Review Checklist

10 things to check before you sign off
on your floor plan

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

This checklist is designed for home buyers and renovators who are about to sign off on floor plans for construction. Work through each section with your plans in front of you.

For each item, tick the box if you're satisfied, or mark it for review if something doesn't feel right. Items marked CRITICAL are the ones most commonly missed and most expensive to fix mid-build.

If you answer 'no' to 3 or more questions, your plan may benefit from a professional review before you commit to construction.

WHAT'S INSIDE

1. Floor Plan Layout & Flow
2. Room Proportions & Furniture Fit
3. Natural Light & Orientation
4. Kitchen, Laundry & Bathroom
5. Indoor-Outdoor Connection
6. Storage & Practical Spaces
7. Street Presence & Elevation
8. Electrical & Lighting Considerations
9. Site Plan & Block Considerations
10. Your Score & Next Steps

SCORING GUIDE

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|----------------------------|---|
| 0-2 items unchecked | Your plan is in good shape. Minor tweaks may still help. |
| 3-5 items unchecked | Worth a closer look. Consider a professional plan review. |
| 6+ items unchecked | Significant issues likely. A professional review is strongly recommended. |

1 Floor Plan Layout & Flow

**CRITICAL**

Does the entry create a good first impression?

The entry sets the tone for the whole home. A cramped or awkward entry makes every arrival feel rushed. Consider ceiling height, width, and sightlines.



Can you walk from the garage to the kitchen without passing through living areas?

You carry groceries this way multiple times a week. A direct path that doesn't cut through the lounge is essential for daily life.



Are the public zones (living, dining, kitchen) separated from private zones (bedrooms)?

Visitors shouldn't walk past your bedroom to reach the bathroom. Separation between public and private zones is a basic planning principle.



Is there a clear circulation path that doesn't cut through rooms?

If you have to walk through the dining room to get to the laundry, that's poor circulation. Every room should be accessible without disrupting another.



Are hallways at least 1000mm wide?

Anything narrower feels cramped and makes furniture delivery difficult. 1200mm is preferred for a comfortable feel.

2 Room Proportions & Furniture Fit

**CRITICAL**

Can you fit a queen/king bed, two bedsidess, and a robe in every bedroom?

Draw your furniture to scale on the plan. A room that measures 3.0 x 3.0m will not fit a queen bed with robes and clearance. You'll discover this on move-in day.



Is the living room the right shape for your furniture?

A long narrow living room has the right square meterage but won't fit a corner sofa and TV properly. Shape matters as much as size.



Is the dining area large enough for your table plus chairs pushed out?

You need 800mm behind each chair for someone to walk past while people are seated. Most plans undersize the dining space.



Are ceiling heights appropriate for each room?

2700mm is the standard minimum for living areas in quality homes. Lower ceilings make rooms feel smaller. Check whether any rooms are reduced height.

3 Natural Light & Orientation

**CRITICAL****Does the living area face north?**

North-facing living areas get sun all day in winter and are easy to shade in summer. South-facing living rooms are dark and cold from May to August. This is the single biggest liveability factor.

**Will any rooms be overshadowed by neighbouring properties?**

Check the height and proximity of neighbouring buildings. A two-storey house next door can cast a shadow over your entire backyard in winter.

**Are there windows on at least two walls of the main living area?**

Cross-ventilation requires openings on two sides. A living room with windows on only one wall will feel stuffy and rely on air conditioning.

**Have you checked the orientation of the block against the plan?**

Flip the plan if needed. A plan designed for a north-facing backyard performs very differently on a south-facing block.

4 Kitchen, Laundry & Bathroom



Does the kitchen have adequate bench space on both sides of the sink?

You need clear benchtop either side of the sink for food prep and drying. A kitchen island doesn't count — you want adjacent workspace.



Is there a direct line between fridge, sink, and cooktop?

This is the kitchen triangle. If these three points are too far apart or have obstacles between them, cooking becomes exhausting.



Is the laundry accessible from the main living zone without a long walk?

You visit the laundry multiple times a day. If it's tucked at the back of the garage, you'll resent the walk.



CRITICAL

Does every bathroom have natural ventilation or a window?

Windowless bathrooms rely entirely on exhaust fans and feel damp and dark. A highlight window provides light and airflow without compromising privacy.

5 Indoor-Outdoor Connection

**CRITICAL**

Is the alfresco directly accessible from the kitchen?

In Australia, the alfresco is often the most-used room in the house. If you can't hand plates through a servery or walk directly from the kitchen, you'll feel the disconnect daily.



Is the outdoor living area on the correct side for afternoon shade?

An alfresco that faces west will be unbearable in summer without significant shade structures. East or south-facing outdoor areas are more comfortable in the afternoon.



Is the alfresco large enough for a table and BBQ with clearance?

Measure your furniture. A 2.5m deep alfresco won't fit a 6-seater table and a BBQ with adequate clearance. 3.5m minimum is recommended.



Are sliding doors or stacker doors wide enough to create a real connection?

A single sliding door doesn't create indoor-outdoor flow. You want at least 2.4m of opening, ideally more, to blur the boundary between inside and out.

6 Storage & Practical Spaces



Is there a linen cupboard in the hallway near the bedrooms?

Sheets, towels, and blankets need to live close to where they're used. A linen cupboard near the garage is functionally useless.



Is the pantry deep enough for a full shelf?

A pantry less than 600mm deep can't fit standard containers. Walk-in pantries sound luxurious but are often poorly proportioned — check the actual shelf layout.



Is there storage near the entry for shoes, bags, and keys?

Every family needs a drop zone at the front door. If your entry has no storage, shoes and bags end up on the floor and keys go missing.



Is there external storage for bins, tools, and garden equipment?

Where do you keep the lawnmower? If there's no shed or external store on the plan, you'll need to solve this after construction — usually at extra cost.

7 Street Presence & Elevation

**CRITICAL**

Does the front elevation have depth and visual interest?

A flat facade with no projections, recesses, or material changes looks cheap. A simple portico or recessed entry adds depth for minimal cost.



Is the garage door visually dominant from the street?

If the garage door is the first thing you see, the home feels like a carpark. Check whether the entry has equal or greater visual weight.



Are the front windows well-proportioned and placed intentionally?

Random window placement reads as poorly designed. Windows should be aligned, grouped, or deliberately asymmetric — not scattered.



Have you considered the fence, landscaping, and letterbox as part of the street presence?

The space between your front door and the street is the first impression for every visitor. Don't leave it as an afterthought.

8

Electrical & Lighting



Have you considered where you'll place TVs, lamps, and chargers?

Powerpoint locations are fixed into walls during construction. Moving them later requires cutting into plasterboard. Think about furniture placement now.



Are there enough powerpoints in the kitchen for all your appliances?

Kettle, toaster, coffee machine, mixer, phone charger — count them. Most kitchens are underspecified for powerpoints.



Have you planned for pendant lights, downlights, or feature lighting?

The electrical plan determines where lights go. If you want a pendant over the dining table, it needs to be specified now, not after the ceiling is plastered.



Are external lights and powerpoints included?

Outdoor entertaining needs light and power. An alfresco without a powerpoint means no speakers, no fairy lights, and no fan.

9

Site Plan & Block



CRITICAL

Does the plan meet all setback requirements for your block?

Every block has mandatory setbacks from boundaries. If the plan doesn't comply, you'll find out at the council stage — and redesigning at that point costs time and money.



Have you checked for easements, sewer lines, or other restrictions?

Easements prevent you from building in certain areas. A sewer line through your backyard may restrict where you can place an alfresco or pool.



Is there enough space for side access to the backyard?

If you ever want a pool, shed, or trailer access, you need at least 1m of clear side passage. Many plans build boundary to boundary with no access.



Have you considered the slope of the block?

A sloping block changes everything — retaining walls, split levels, and drainage all add cost. Make sure the plan accounts for the actual site levels.

10 Your Score & Next Steps

Count your unchecked items: _____ / 38

0-2 unchecked

Your plan is solid. Minor refinements may still improve it.

3-5 unchecked

Some issues worth addressing before you sign. Consider a professional review.

6+ unchecked

Significant gaps. A professional review before construction is strongly recommended.

WANT A PROFESSIONAL SET OF EYES?

Get your plan reviewed for \$395

A design manager with 15+ years of experience records a 15-minute Loom video walking through your plan, plus a one-page PDF summary with specific recommendations ranked by impact.

planreview.com.au

hello@planreview.com.au | @plan.review on Instagram

This checklist is design commentary only. It does not constitute engineering, structural, or compliance advice.
Always consult qualified professionals before making construction decisions.